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CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
ADVANCED PROFICIENCY EXAMINATION
COMMUNICATION STUDIES

PAPER 02

2 hours 30 minutes

13 MAY 2004 (p.m.)

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Answer ALL questions.

SECTION A

MODULE 1 – GATHERING AND PROCESSING INFORMATION

1. Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow.

The value of taking supplements, vitamins and minerals is often questioned by many.

They often ask: Do we really need to take supplements?

If you are basically healthy, is there any advantage to taking supplements on a regular basis?

And, if you develop a disorder or ailment, can you expect supplements to offer any help?

The general consensus has long been that as long as people who seem healthy eat well enough to avoid specific nutritional deficiencies, they don't need to supplement their diet.

The only thing they have to do is to consume a diet that meets the Recommended Daily Allowances (RDA) and other guidelines for vitamin and mineral intakes.

And therein lies the problem.

Even if people accept the RDA standards do provide vitamin and mineral intakes that are adequate for good health, the evidence is overwhelming that most people don't even come close to meeting those basic nutritional requirements.

Surveys show that only nine per cent of all people in industrialised countries eat five daily servings of fresh fruits and vegetables – the amount recommended for obtaining the minimum level of nutrients believed necessary to prevent illness.

For example, average calcium consumption in the United States and Canada is estimated to be about 60 per cent of the current suggested level of 1 000 mg for young adults, and far below the 1 200 mg recommended for men and women ages 50 to 70.

According to a review of national data by experts at the University of California, Berkeley, people often make food choices that are nutritionally poor.

For example, they are more likely to select french fries than broccoli as a vegetable serving, and will generally select a soft drink rather than water, fruit juice, or a glass of skim milk as a beverage.

Not only may these and other foods contribute too much fat and sugar to your diet, but they can also result in less than optimal intakes of vitamins, amino acid, chelated minerals and disease fighting phytonutrients.

Many diets, these experts point out, contain half the recommended amounts of magnesium and folic acid. Vitamins A, C and B6, as well as iron and zinc, are other nutrients that surveys show are at very low levels in most people's diets.

Even with the best nutritional planning it is difficult to maintain a diet that meets the RDA's for all nutrients.

For example, vegetarians, who as a group are healthier than meat eaters, still may be deficient in some nutrients, such as iron, calcium, and Vitamin B12.

And most people who want to maintain a healthy low-fat diet will have a problem obtaining the recommended amounts of Vitamin E from their food alone, because so many food sources for Vitamin E are high in fat.

Another complication is that a balanced diet may not contain the more specialised substances such as fish oils, soy isoflavones, enzymes, or alpha-lipoic acid that researchers think may promote health.

For generally healthy people who cannot always eat a well-balanced diet everyday, a supplement can fill in these nutritional gaps and/or boost the nutrients they consume from adequate to optimal.

There are various other reasons why people who maintain good eating habits might benefit from a daily supplement.

Nutritional scientists now believe that exposure to environmental pollutants such as car emissions and industrial chemicals and wastes can cause damage in many ways inside the body at the cellular level, destroying tissues and depleting the body of vital nutrients.

Many supplements, particularly those that act as antioxidants, can help control the cell and tissue damage that follows toxic exposure.

Recent evidence also indicates that certain medications, excess alcohol, smoking, and stress may interfere with the absorption of certain key nutrients. Even an excellent diet would be unable to make up for such a shortfall.

In conclusion, specific nutritional programmes of vitamins, minerals, and other supplements take into account these and other environmental and lifestyle factors which affect nutrient levels in the human body.

Therefore, their use affords you an excellent opportunity to enhance your diet and, by extension, your life.

*"Value in Vitamins", Better Health,
May - June 2002, Nation Publishing Co. Limited, p. 4.*

- (a) State the writer's main purpose in no more than 30 words.
- (b) Write an essay of no more than 500 words in which you include reference to the following:
 - (i) The writer's purpose
 - (ii) Strategies and language techniques used
 - (iii) Appropriateness of the tone and register used.

[25 marks]

SECTION B

MODULE 2 – LANGUAGE AND COMMUNITY

2. Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow.

‘That’s why this country will nevah get ahead, nevah get ahead,’ she say, walking round her beauty parlour like a bee just sting her. She fold up towels, hang up robes, straighten things that don’t need straightening.

I wish Pinkie would cool down, though. ‘People here have no discipline,’ she saying. ‘The whole time I was in England, there wasn’t one power cut, and that’s a big, prosperous country. Now look at this little island that can’t hold its head above water and every minute somebody’s on strike.’

I start to tell her that I hear bout a whole heap of strikes in England, but I change my mind. I don’t feel like arguing. I just want her to wash my hair and braid it. You don’t need electricity for that. But she keep on walking up and down.

She getting on my nerves now. Why she have to criticise the island so much when is the only place we have for we-selves?

I say, ‘Look, Pinkie, you can wash my hair. At least some sunshine coming in, so you can see what you doing.’

‘To tell you the truth, Miss Daisy, I don’t feel like doing any work today.’

The last time I see Pinkie, she shining like a morning star.

‘Guess wha’, Miss Daisy, guess wha’?’

I can’t believe is she talking. The English accent gone clean.

‘What?’ I say. ‘What?’

‘I get visa to go to America. I go to the embassy from five o’clock this morning, stand up three hours in line before it open and when I tell the man I going to visit a cousin who gettin married, he never ask me a thing, just stamp ‘multiple indefinite’ in me passport. Is gone I gone, you know. First plane I can get on. It too hot here, Miss Daisy, too hot. Can’t stand the sun. Now how you want your hair done today?’

*Adapted from Alecia McKenzie, “Pinkie”, Satellite City and other Stories
Longman Group U.K. Ltd., 1992, pp. 28 - 30.*

In an essay of no more than 500 words, discuss the use of language in the excerpt, concentrating on the following:

- (a) The relation between the writer’s use of language and the context of the narrative
- (b) The appropriateness of the narrator’s language
- (c) Whether Pinkie’s language was motivated by linguistic and/or non-linguistic factors
- (d) Ways in which a video presentation of this interaction would help to highlight the fact that these are Caribbean speakers communicating in a Caribbean setting.

[25 marks]

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SECTION C

MODULE 3 – SPEAKING AND WRITING

3. Read the scenario below and answer the questions that follow.

Your community market has just been renovated and vendors and authorities are quite pleased with the results. However, at a management meeting the need for vendors to cooperate with the authorities to maintain the market's cleanliness, has been raised. You have been approached to conduct a campaign to make vendors aware of their responsibilities. You are well aware that the subject matter must be handled in a delicate manner.

Discuss the approach you would take in creating the campaign in terms of:

- (a) The communication challenges you would expect to find when targeting the vendors
- (b) The information that must be relayed, and the vocabulary and register you would consider appropriate
- (c) Any other organisational strategies, as well as visual approaches you would employ in your campaign.

[25 marks]

END OF TEST

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